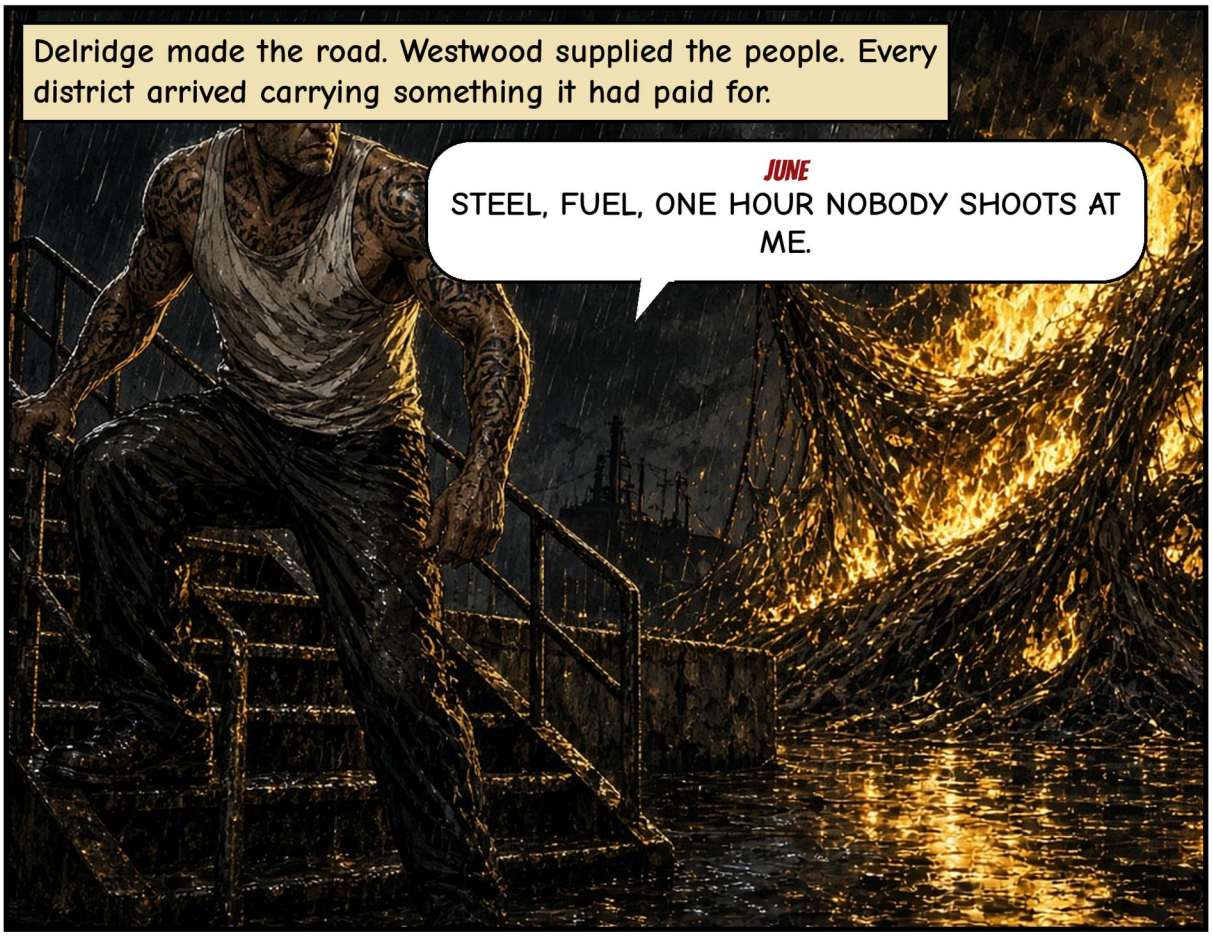
# SOLACE

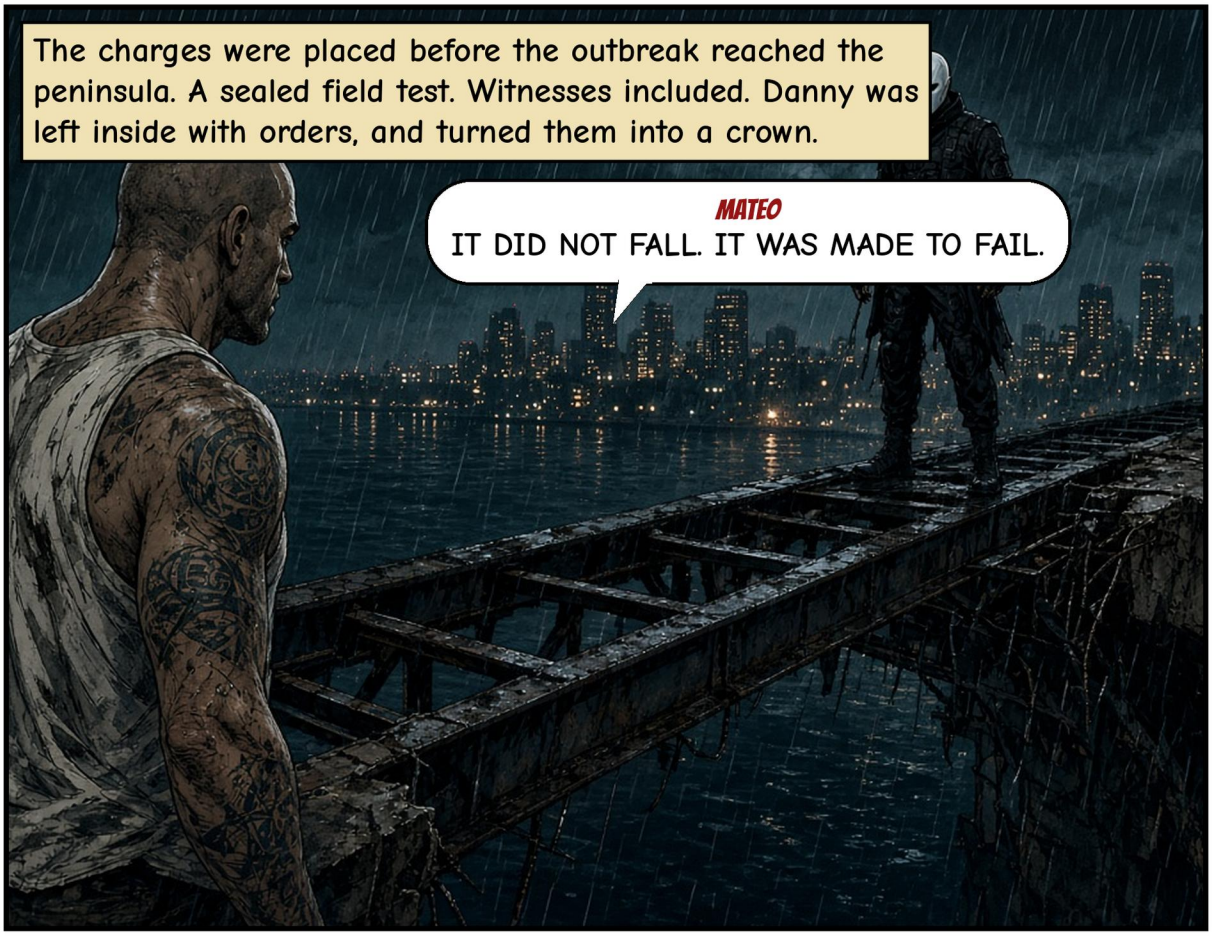
## THE LIGHT STAYS ON

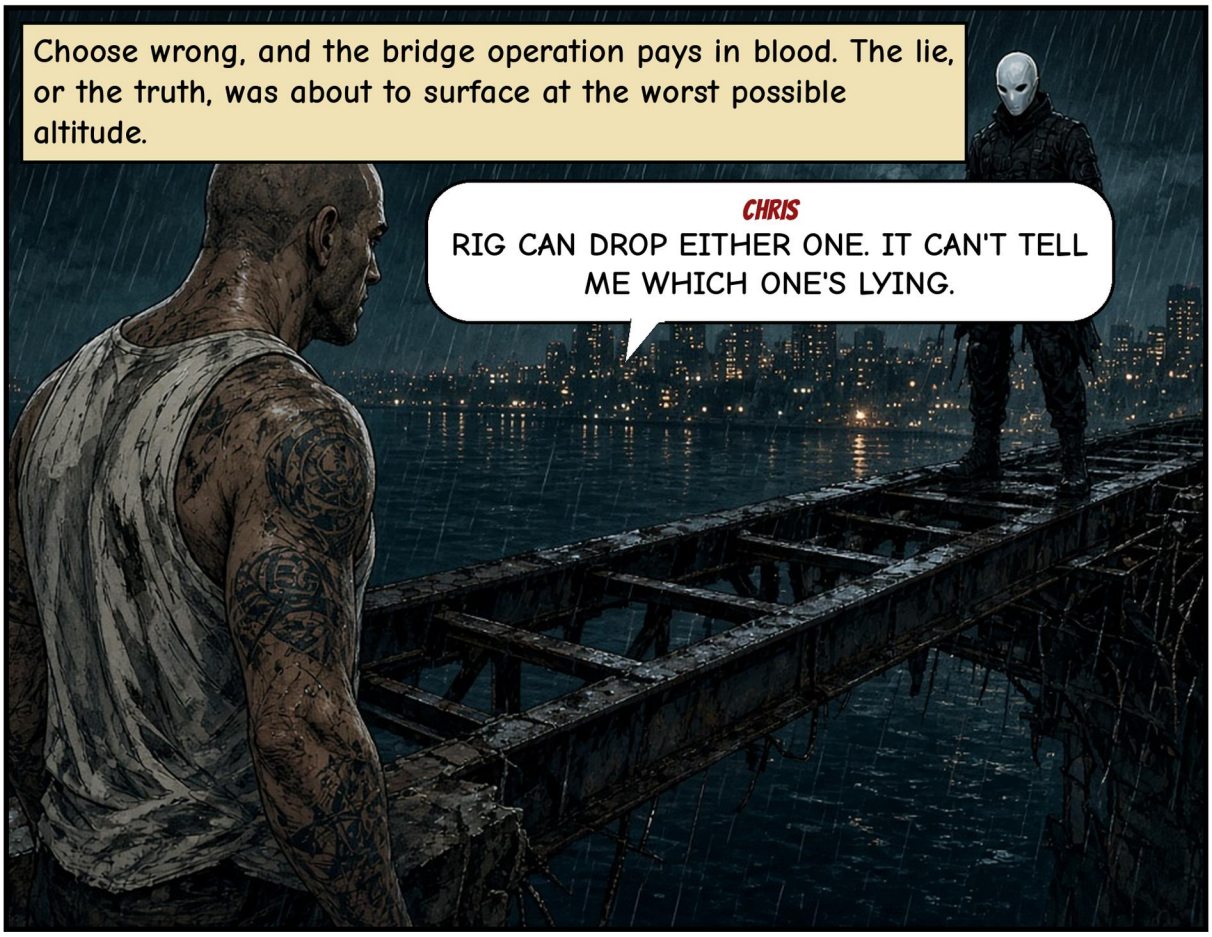


CHAOTIC DESIGNS

ISSUE #5


Delridge made the road. Westwood supplied the people. Every district arrived carrying something it had paid for.
JUNE
STEEL, FUEL, ONE HOUR NOBODY SHOOTS AT ME.


The charges were placed before the outbreak reached the peninsula. A sealed field test. Witnesses included. Danny was left inside with orders, and turned them into a crown.
MATEO
IT DID NOT FALL. IT WAS MADE TO FAIL.


Choose wrong, and the bridge operation pays in blood. The lie, or the truth, was about to surface at the worst possible altitude.
CHRIS
RIG CAN DROP EITHER ONE. IT CAN'T TELL ME WHICH ONE'S LYING.

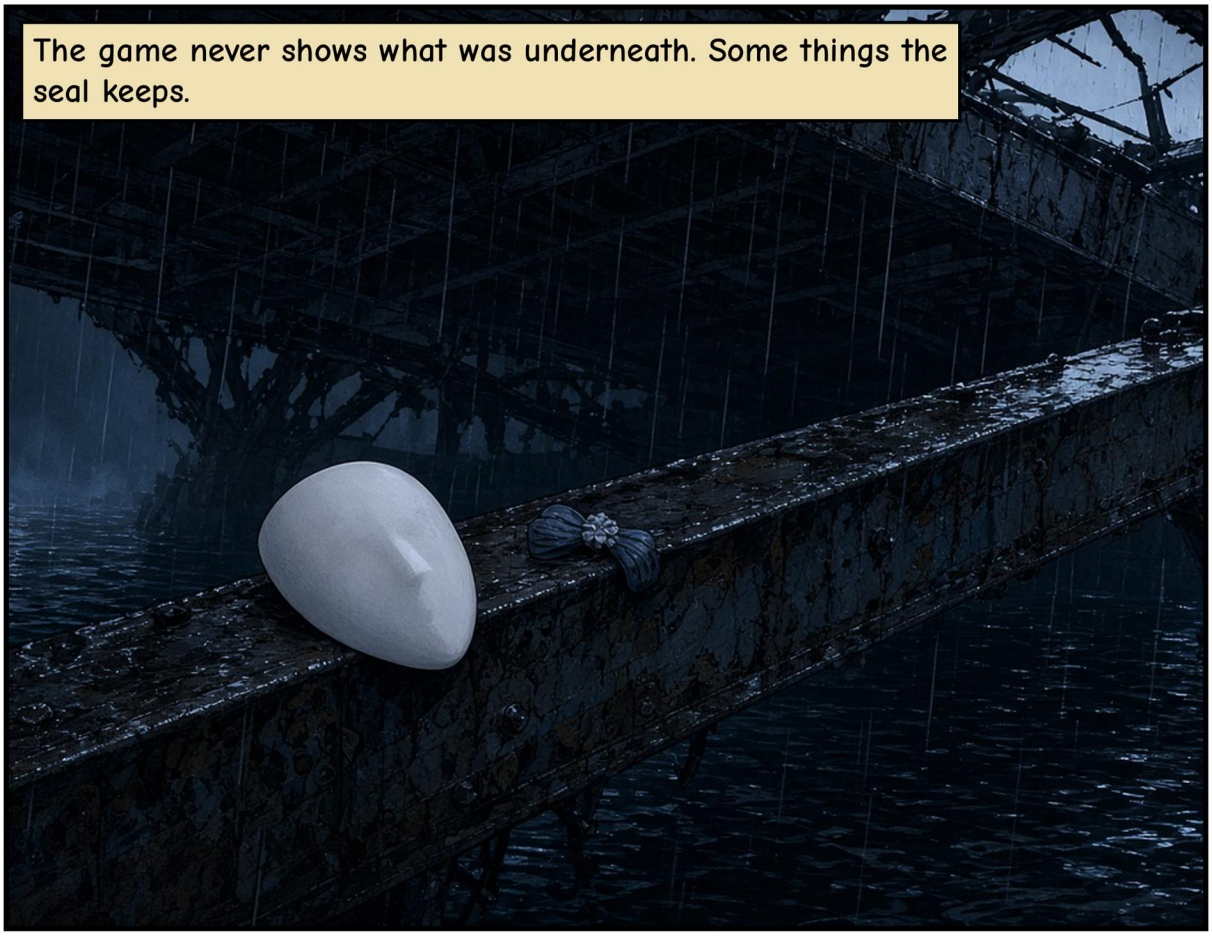

On the broadcast table, open, sat Keith's ledger.
RAE (RADIO)
ALKI. ADMIRAL. JUNCTION. MORGAN. LINCOLN. DELRIDGE. WESTWOOD. HIGH POINT. ALL LIGHTS REPORT.


DANNY
YOU OPEN THAT CHANNEL AND YOU SIGN THEIR DEATHS. THE MATH ISN'T CRUEL, IAN. IT'S JUST MATH.
IAN
YOUR MATH. NOT MINE.

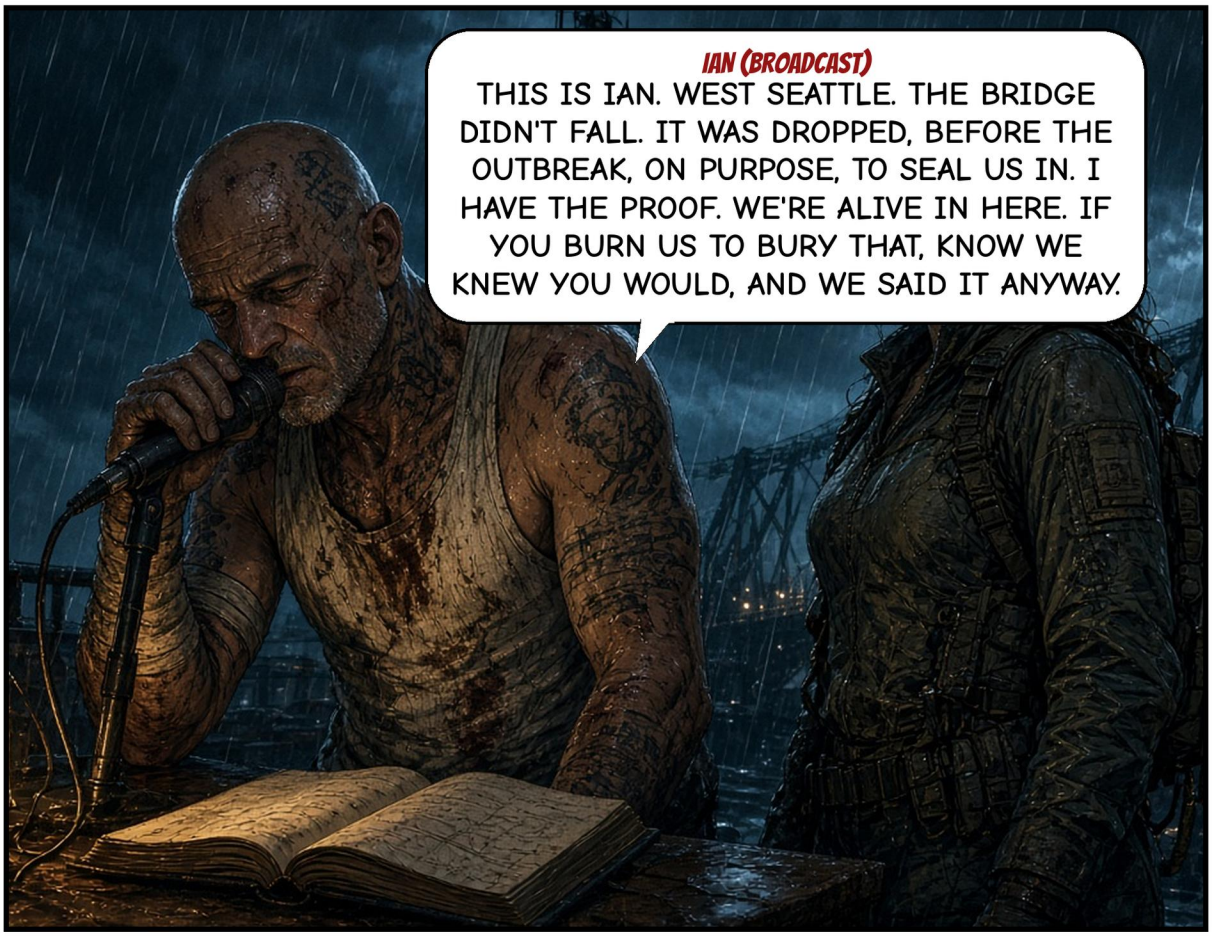

DANNY
EVERYONE YOU LOVE IS INSIDE MY ARITHMETIC.
IAN
THEN I'LL BREAK IT.

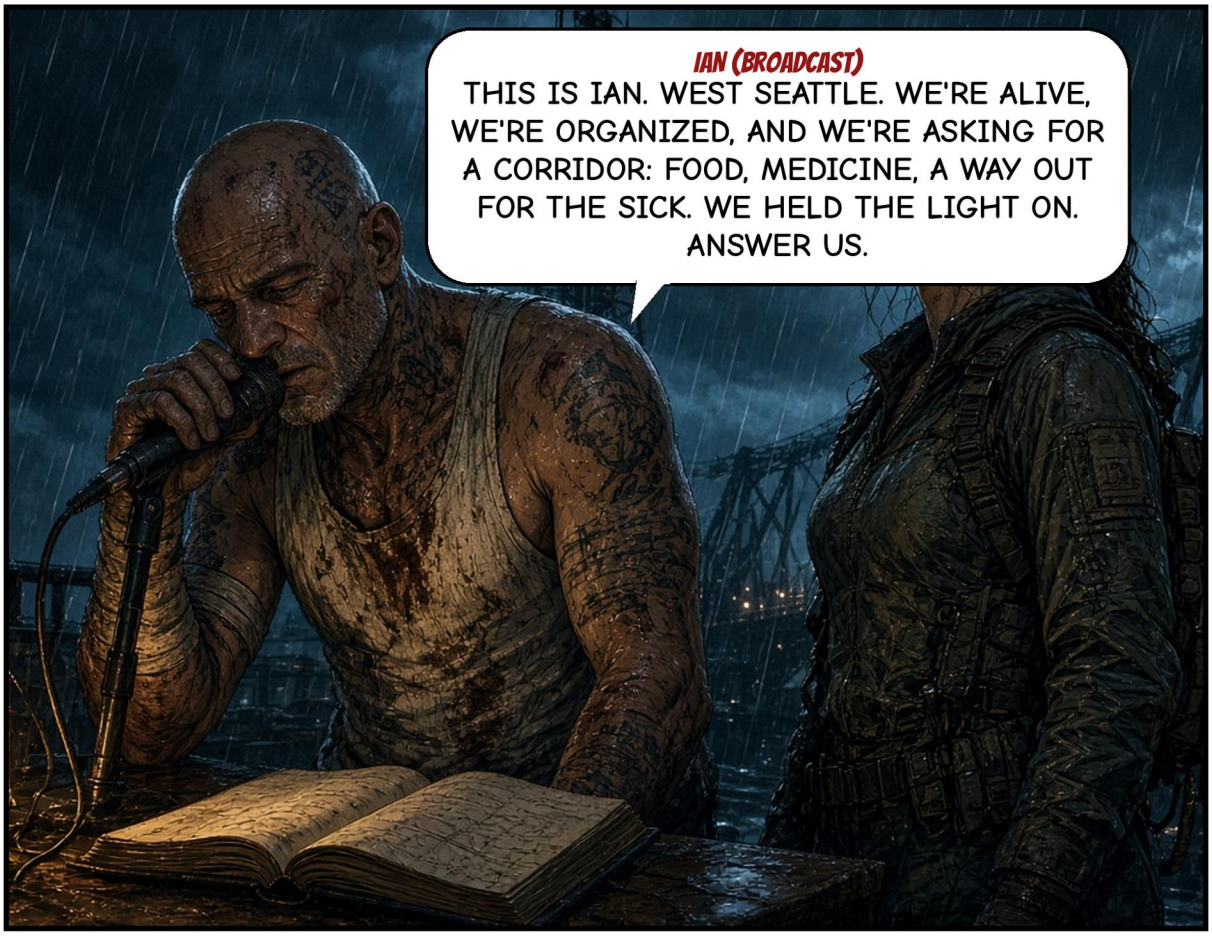

Whoever was losing got one last hold. Ian's held.

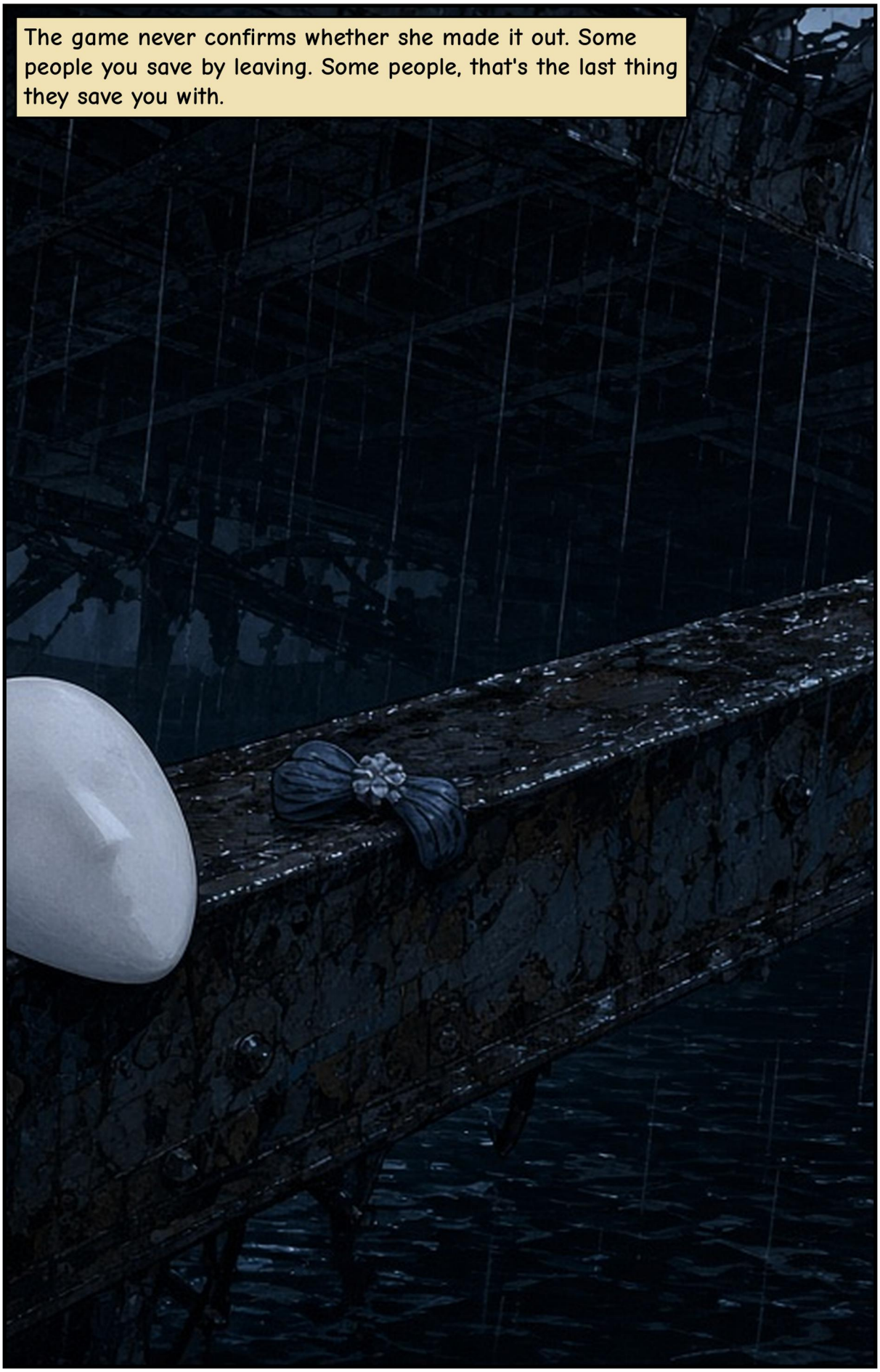

The game doesn't tell you which man Ian is. You do.
MISSY (RADIO)
WHAT DID YOU LEAVE DOWN THERE?


The game never shows what was underneath. Some things the seal keeps.


DANNY (RADIO)
YOU OPEN THAT CHANNEL AND YOU SIGN THEIR DEATHS. YOU KNOW I'M RIGHT.
MISSY
ALL OF IT, OR THE VERSION THAT KEEPS THEM BREATHING. CHOOSE LIKE IT'S YOURS. IT IS.


IAN (BROADCAST)
THIS IS IAN. WEST SEATTLE. THE BRIDGE DIDN'T FALL. IT WAS DROPPED, BEFORE THE OUTBREAK, ON PURPOSE, TO SEAL US IN. I HAVE THE PROOF. WE'RE ALIVE IN HERE. IF YOU BURN US TO BURY THAT, KNOW WE KNEW YOU WOULD, AND WE SAID IT ANYWAY.


IAN (BROADCAST)
THIS IS IAN. WEST SEATTLE. WE'RE ALIVE, WE'RE ORGANIZED, AND WE'RE ASKING FOR A CORRIDOR: FOOD, MEDICINE, A WAY OUT FOR THE SICK. WE HELD THE LIGHT ON. ANSWER US.


The game never confirms whether she made it out. Some people you save by leaving. Some people, that's the last thing they save you with.


MISSY
YOU CROSSED ALL THAT TO FIND ME.
IAN
NO. I CROSSED IT SO WE COULD CHOOSE WHAT HAPPENS NEXT.


It is no longer silent. The light stays on.


TO BE CONTINUED...